

2026 Cybersecurity - AppSec Eng - Study Tracker

Week 11 – hours, mins over days

09/28/26, Mon – 12 hrs, 3 mins

-Continue study plan validation checks, focusing on rule/V validation – 12 hrs, 3 mins

Week 10 – 26 hours, 46 mins over 3 days

09/27/26, Sun – 9 hrs, 48 mins

-Continue study plan validation checks, with many issues still being fixed – 9 hrs, 48 mins

09/22/26, Tue – 5 hrs, 50 mins

-Continue study plan validation checks, with many issues still being fixed – 5 hrs, 50 mins

09/21/26, Mon – 11 hrs, 8 mins

-Continue study plan validation checks, with many issues still being fixed – 11 hrs, 8 mins

Week 09 – 37 hours, 25 mins over 5 days

09/20/26, Sun – 6 hrs, 17 mins

-Continue study plan validation checks, with many issues still being fixed – 6 hrs, 17 mins

09/19/26, Sat – 6 hrs, 36 mins

-Continue study plan validation checks, with many issues still being fixed – 6 hrs, 36 mins

09/18/26, Fri – 12 hrs, 1 mins

-Continue study plan validation checks, with many issues still being fixed – 12 hrs, 1 mins

09/17/26, Thu – 6 hrs, 9 mins

-Continue study resource contents validation checks - resource *Exp vs Act* contents diff – 3 hrs, 12 mins

-Continue study resource contents validation checks - resource *Exp vs Act* contents diff – 2 hrs, 57 mins

09/16/26, Weds – 6 hrs, 22 mins

-Continue and finish edits on study plan w/ Claude Fable 5.1 – 1 hr, 9 mins

-02-03: Finish Real-World Bug... Ch. 5 (HTML Inj. / Content Spoof) & take notes – 1 hrs, 13 mins

-02-04: Started reading TryHackMe [Writing Pentest Reports](#) room & taking notes – 57 mins

-Start a study resource contents validation script as resource *Exp vs Act* contents diff – 4 hrs, 3 mins

Week 08 – 25 hours, 39 mins over 5 days

09/12/26, Sun – 3 hrs, 57 mins

-02-03: Complete Real-World Bug Hunting Ch. 4 (CSRF) and take notes – 1 hr, 30 mins

-02-03: Start Real-World Bug Hunting Ch. 5 (HTML Inj. / Content Spoof) & take notes – 37 mins

-Transfer study plan to Claude Fable 5.1 & fix errors in it w/ Fable as Opus 4.8 is trash – 1 hr, 50 mins

09/12/26, Sat – 4 hrs, 12 mins

-02-03: Read Real-World Bug Hunting Ch. 3 (HTTP Param Pollution) and take notes – 2 hrs, 35 mins

-02-03: Start Real-World Bug Hunting Ch. 4 (CSRF) and take notes – 1 hr, 37 mins

09/11/26, Fri – 5 hrs, 10 mins

-02-01: Finish THM [Burp Suite: Basics](#) reading and complete remaining quizzes – 55 mins

-02-02: Continue PortSwigger [SQL injection](#) & complete labs [SQLi w/ XML filter bypass](#) – 20 mins

- Edit study plan for errors some in repetition and ordering of phase steps – 1 hr, 31 mins
- 02-02: Start PortSwigger [XSS](#) docs & complete labs [Reflected XSS](#) and [Stored XSS](#) – 22 mins
- 02-03: Read Real-World Bug Hunting Ch. 1 (Bug Bounty Basics) and take notes – 46 mins
- 02-03: Read Real-World Bug Hunting Ch. 2 (Open Redirect) and take notes – 51 mins
- Update notes README to include RWBH notes & push changes for notes/tracker/plan – 9 mins
- Update FastAPI project to create *data/sqlite* dir in Docker image for DO deploys - 16 mins

09/10/26, Thu – 5 hrs, 3 mins

- 01-03: Quick FastAPI practice app updates to fix some REST/DDD standard issues – 1 hr, 2 mins
- 02-02: Install Burp Suite community edition on Linux Mint – 5 mins
- 02-02: Start PortSwigger [SQL injection](#) material & complete lab [SQLi in WHERE...](#) - 45 mins
- 02-02: Continue PortSwigger [SQL injection](#) material & complete lab [SQLi login bypass](#) - 29 mins
- Fix Study Plan ordering issue for steps in Phase II – 22 mins
- 02-01: Complete TryHackMe reading [HTTP in Detail](#) & take lesson quizzes – 47 mins
- 02-01: Sign up for THM Premium, start reading of [Burp Suite: Basics](#) & take quizzes – 1 hr, 24 mins
- Push update to notes for added TryHackMe notes and update README for Notes – 9 mins

09/09/26, Wed – 7 hrs, 17 mins

- Update study analysis log – 1 hr, 17 mins
- 01-03: FastAPI docs [Behind a Proxy](#) and [Testing Dependencies with Overrides](#) – 1 hr, 33 mins
- 01-03: FastAPI docs [Settings and Env Var](#) and [Strict Content-Type Checking](#) – 1 hr, 31 mins
- 01-03: Edit FastAPI notes for full accuracy, spelling, & grammar w/ Claude – 2 hrs, 56 mins

Week 07 – 0 hours over 0 days

*Take time off to do bike touring trip to shore and back w/ partner

Week 06 – 8 hours, 30 mins over 2 days

08/26/2026, Wed – 6 hrs, 25 mins

- 01-03: Continue reading FastAPI docs [OAuth2 Scopes](#) (Claude re-organize/write) – 2 hrs, 50 mins
- 01-03: Complete reading FastAPI docs [OAuth2 Scopes](#) (Claude re-organize/write) – 3 hrs, 35 mins

08/25/2026, Tue – 2 hrs, 5 mins

- 01-03: Start reading FastAPI docs [OAuth2 Scopes](#) 36 mins
- 01-03: FastAPI docs for [OAuth2 Scopes](#) are garbled mess. Re-write with Claude. – 1 hr, 29 mins

Week 05 – 19 hours, 45 mins over 4 days

08/22/2026, Sat – 4 hrs, 45 mins

- 01-03: Start & Complete FastAPI docs section [Debugging](#) - 1 hr, 41 mins
- Review “actual” vs “expected” study time done vs planned with Claude – 24 mins
- 01-03: Start & Complete FastAPI docs section [Response Cookies](#) - 48 mins
- 01-03: Start & Complete sections [Response Headers](#) & [Advanced Dependencies](#) – 1 hr, 52 mins

08/21/2026, Fri – 4 hrs, 36 mins

- 01-03: Complete reading FastAPI docs [SQL + RDBMS](#) section + Project work – 1 hr, 28 mins
- Cancel mentorship as too early in plan to be worthwhile & update study plan doc – 30 mins
- 01-03: Start & Complete FastAPI docs section [Bigger Apps – Multi Files](#) - 1 hr, 32 mins
- 01-03: Start & Complete FastAPI docs section [Testing](#) - 1 hr, 6 mins

08/20/2026, Thu – 5 hrs, 28 mins

- 01-03: Continue reading FastAPI docs ([SQL + RDBMS](#)) + Project work – 3 hrs, 26 mins
- 01-03: Continue reading FastAPI docs ([SQL + RDBMS](#)) + Project work – 31 mins
- 01-03: Continue reading FastAPI docs ([SQL + RDBMS](#)) + Project work – 1 hr, 31 mins

08/18/2026, Tue – 4 hrs, 56 mins

- 01-03: Review of FastAPI docs notes – hrs, 25 mins
- 01-03: Update FastAPI Project to skip some “out of scope” notes – 1 hr, 22 mins
- 01-03: Continue reading FastAPI docs ([Middleware](#)) + Project work – 23 mins
- 01-03: Continue reading FastAPI docs ([CORS](#)) + Project work – 28 mins
- 01-03: Continue reading FastAPI docs ([SQL + RDBMS](#)) + Project work – 2 hrs, 8 mins
- 01-03: Have Claude run a full test suite on FastAPI work – 10 mins

Week 04 – 20 hours, 23 mins over 4 days

08/14/2026, Fri – 8 hrs, 19 mins

- 01-03: Continue reading FastAPI docs (Security) + Project work – 3 hrs, 45 mins
- 01-03: Finished reading FastAPI docs “Security” section + Project work – 4 hrs, 34 mins

08/12/2026, Wed – 3 hrs, 56 mins

- Update study plan schedule to operate at 25 hrs / week vs 35 hrs / week w/ Claude - 39 mins
- 01-03: Continue reading FastAPI docs (Security) + Project work – 3 hrs, 17 mins

08/11/2026, Tue - 5 hrs, 4 mins

- 01-03: Finish reading FastAPI docs "Dependency Injection" + Project work - 1 hr, 48 mins
- 01-03: Start reading FastAPI docs "Security" + Project work - 51 mins
- 01-03: Continue reading FastAPI docs (Security) + Project work - 2 hrs, 25 mins

08/10/2026, Mon - 3 hrs, 4 mins

- Create comparison spreadsheet to track weekly '18 web dev vs '26 cyb self-teach hrs - 15 mins
- 01-03: Continue reading FastAPI docs (Dependency Injection) + Project work - 2 hrs
- 01-03: Continue reading FastAPI docs (Dependency Injection) + Project work - 44 mins
- Commit end of day changes across tracker, FastAPI project, FastAPI notes - 5 mins

Week 03 - 17 hours, 38 mins over 4 days

08/06/2026, Thu - 5 hrs, 44 mins

- 01-03: Continue reading FastAPI docs (Dependency Injection) + Project work - 4 hrs, 17 mins
- 01-03: Continue reading FastAPI docs (Dependency Injection) + Project work - 37 mins
- 01-03: Edit FastAPI notes with Claude for grammar, spelling, accuracy - 50 mins

08/05/2026, Wed - 4 hrs, 15 mins

- 01-03: Continue reading FastAPI docs (Errors and config) + Project work. - 1 hr, 7 mins
- Review of recent work + future timing with Claude. Diff repo README updates. - 1 hr, 3 mins
- 01-03: Continue reading FastAPI docs (Errors and config) + Project work - 2 hrs, 5 mins

08/04/2026, Tue - 5 hrs, 39 mins

- 01-03: Continue reading FastAPI docs (Forms & Fields) + Project work - 1 hr, 26 mins
- Quick Claude comparison of study time this round versus web dev self-teaching in 2018 - 8 mins
- 01-03: Continue reading FastAPI docs (HTTP Exception Handling) + Project work - 48 mins

- 01-03: Continue reading FastAPI docs (Custom Exception Handling) + Project work - 1 hr, 4 mins
- 01-03: FastAPI app becoming BBoM...split into better biz directed DDD layers - 2 hrs, 13 mins

08/03/2026, Mon - 2 hrs

- 01-03: Continue reading FastAPI docs + Project work - 2 hrs

Week 02 - 21 hours, 5 mins over 4 days

***Note:** Busy week outside cyb. Cat was spayed on Monday, which consumed M-Tu. Then hanging posters for Philadelphia Unnamed Film Fest all days Sat & Sun.

08/01/2026, Sat - 56 mins

- 01-03: Continuing reading FastAPI docs + project work - 43 mins
- Investigate and work through bug preventing VS Code stopping Claude Code login - 13 mins

07/31/2026, Fri - 6 hrs, 11 mins

- 01-03: Replace best practices bad route, have Claude review API, then [deploy on DO](#) - 1 hr, 42 mins
- 01-03: Finished "Body - Multiple Parameters" section of FastAPI tutorial & update API - 1 hr, 36 mins
- 01-03: Read a few more sections of FastAPI docs + API work - 2 hr, 53 mins

07/30/2026, Thu - 7 hrs, 55 mins

- Update study tracker git from yesterday's work and clean-up cluttered linux desktops - 8 mins
- Update study plan to correct ambiguous week study periods across phases - 7 mins
- 01-03: FastAPI Study Plan Claude README work ADD ONTO - 5 mins
- Write & send MentorCruise mentor response - 7 mins
- Investigate memory leak, upgrade linux, and order new stick of RAM - 2 hrs, 20 mins
- Investigate why LibreOffice is so slow on Linux Mint 22 and install OnlyOffice - 34 mins
- 01-03: Read FastAPI ch. "Path Parameters and Numeric Validations" & do project work - 51 mins
- 01-03: Continuing reading FastAPI chapters - 3 hrs, 11 mins
- 01-03: Add API to Portfolio RM, API notes to notes, & create RM for FastAPI project - 32 mins

07/29/2026, Wed - 6 hrs, 3 mins

- 01-03: Finish FastAPI review of existing notes & build tutorial [FastAPI Project](#) - 4 hrs, 22 mins
- Start fix issue in study plan where steps overlap over vague boundaries - 15 mins
- 01-03: Continue with new FastAPI docs via "Query Params & String Validations" ch. - 1 hr, 26 mins

Week 01 - 24 hours, 6 mins over 5 days

07/24/2026, Fri - 45 mins

- Set up workspaces again after restarting laptop - 7 mins
- Figure out proper monitor for desk size (S2721DS) then buy used, for split screen work - 38 mins

07/23/2026, Thu - 7 hrs, 14 mins

- 01-04: Fix a few [Docker project](#) errors + create asciinema recording on Digital Ocean - 7 hrs, 14 mins

07/22/2026, Wed - 7 hrs, 20 mins

- 01-02: Review of MySQL & DB Design note cards # 36 thru 100, 1x each - 52 mins
- 01-02: Read MDN cookies doc & take notes w/ focus on cookie security steps - 1 hr, 28 mins
- 01-04: Finish reviewing docker notes (skip swarm) - 1 hr, 17 mins
- 01-04: [Build](#) DOCKERFILE & docker compose practice uvicorn + FastAPI image - 1 hrs, 40 mins
- 01-03: Review "An Overview of Programming Paradigms & Web Languages" notes - 14 mins

- 03-02: Review "Designing Web APIs Notes" notes -18 mins
- 03-02: Start reading old FastAPI notes again + [build](#) docker setup for app - 39 mins
- Once again re-do project arrangement, making Portfolio just an index. README for docker - 37 mins
- Split Study Plan build & edit weeks out into own tracker to allow better tracking here - 15 mins

07/21/2026, Tue - 6 hrs, 2 mins

- 01-04: Resume docker review w/ [dockerfile](#) practice - 1 hr, 8 mins
- Mod project organization for GH: profile, plan, tracker, notes, portfolio + update RM - 2 hrs, 34 mins
- 01-02: Reviewed MySQL & DB Design notes & SQL/NoSQL in Sys Design notes - 1 hrs, 9 mins
- 01-02: Reviewed MySQL & DB Design note cards # 1 thru 35, 3x each - 1 hr, 5 mins
- Update a few diff GH repos to denote changes made during end of day - 6 mins

07/20/2026, Mon - 2 hrs, 45 mins

- 01-04: Update Phase 0, Step 4 (docker review) to make step more AppSec relevant - 42 mins
- Re-do study plan to be more expedited, with 35 hrs / week - 41 mins
- 01-04: Start reviewing Docker notes w/ practice commands during - 1 hr, 22 mins

Week 00 (partial week) - 7 hours, 22 mins over 2 days

07/16/2026, Thu - 2 hrs, 32 mins

- Claude convert Study Plan into .odt format while I add phase tracking to study tracker - 11 mins
- Gather notes, note cards, & note files to add to Notes project & for review in Phase I - 16 mins
- 01-01: Read *Git 101* notes - 14 mins
- 01-02: Review Web Basic & HTTP notes/NC, testing self on first NC review (pass) 2x - 46 mins
- 01-04: Review Docker notes' start, update D on nix, then pulled & setup nginx - 1 hr, 19 mins

07/15/2026, Wed - 4 hrs, 50 mins

- Final edit checks of Cyb Study Plan, as performed by Claude - 15 mins
- Read through start of Cyb Study Plan & create/edit "Intro to Cybersecurity" notes - 1 hr, 55 mins
- 01-01: Update GH profile for cyb, then create notes and study guide repos - 1 hr, 23 mins
- 01-01: LinkedIn account is locked due to not logging in for awhile...unlock attempt work - 21 mins
- Reviewed various cyb mentors on MentorCruise, then applied to one - 17 mins
- 01-01: Create README for FastAPI project on GitHub and update other README - 27 mins
- Respond to MentorCruise initial message - 12 mins